



TWELVE-MONTH PROGRESS REPORT

Liberia: progress report, 2025-08-01 to 2026-08-17

Edition of 2026-08-18 · 59 systems and instruments tracked, 8 of them not held

Compiled 2026-08-17 from the Data Landscapers source base. Sections follow the status report. Each opens with a movement ledger comparing the position at the start and end of the period, which runs to the date of issue rather than to the last month's close.

Of 59 systems and instruments on this place's ledger, 34 changed position between 2025-08-01 and 2026-08-17, 10 did not, 7 carry no stated baseline, and 8 are **Not held** at both ends.

Shape check, run before the comparison: 72 sources for this place in the window — 23 in the earlier half (2025-08 to 2026-02), 49 in the later (2026-03 to 2026-08). The two halves are comparable, so the comparison is made over the whole window.

Movement values. *Advanced* — a system entered service, a stage was completed or an instrument was made. *Stalled* — a stated target passed without delivery. *Regressed* — an instrument was withdrawn or neutralised, or a measured position worsened. *Closed* — the programme ended. *No change* — the position at both ends is the same. *Baseline not held* — the base carries no position at the start of the period, so no movement can be stated. A value may carry a qualifying clause after a comma, as in *Advanced, slipped*.

Summary of the period

The clearest movement of the twelve months to 9 August 2026 was in payments, where an interoperable instant payment system went from not existing to running across both mobile-money networks with a published fee schedule. The clearest regression was in the system the state depends on most: national identity enrolment stopped, with [about 640,000 prior registrants locked out over a US\\$1.7m unpaid balance](#), and the remedy adopted was to concede the register to a foreign operator. Around both, the state built coordination machinery — a whole-of-government digital office, a five-year strategy, a reformed licensing regime — while the data-protection Bill stayed where it was a year ago.

Infrastructure

Connectivity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
5G network services	Did not exist	Plans stated with investors still being engaged; no spectrum award, licence condition or launch date published (2026-01)	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Second submarine cable landing at Buchanan	One submarine cable in Monrovia; a second landing at Buchanan not yet stated (2025-08)	Second landing at Buchanan sought, with partial funding stated as sourced and investors still being sought; no landing partner, cost or date published (2026-07)	ADVANCED
Starcell International Liberia licence	Licensed but not operating since 2020, under a 90-day suspension from 9 February 2026	Revoked, with spectrum, numbering and regulatory privileges reverting to the regulator (2026-07)	CLOSED
Telecoms traffic monitoring concession	Concession with Telecom International Alliance operating, ratified by the legislature in 2022 and held valid by the Ministry of Justice in 2024 (2025-08)	Suspended, with a joint legislative committee recommending renegotiation rather than cancellation, operator funds in escrow of undisclosed amount, and a corruption complaint under investigation (2026-07)	REGRESSED
TRANSCO CLSG spare fibre commercialisation	Sole reliance on the ACE cable landing in Monrovia, with no terrestrial redundancy agreed (2025-08)	Agreement in principle to commercialise spare fibre across Liberia, Sierra Leone, Guinea and Cote d'Ivoire; no operator, tariff or date published (2026-06)	ADVANCED
Domestic fibre-optic backbone extension	BASELINE NOT HELD	Line reported reaching Loguatu from Monrovia with private firms extending it south-east; no route map, kilometre figure or completion date published (2026-01)	<i>Baseline not held</i>
Starlink School Connect programme	BASELINE NOT HELD	About 90 of 156 public high schools connected; no funder, cost or completion date published (2026-07)	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Data Storage

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
National data centre	Did not exist	Announced to hold government data domestically; no site, cost, timetable or operator named (2026-07)	ADVANCED
Tier III+ data centre at Buchanan	BASELINE NOT HELD	Stated as under development for sovereign hosting of the National Identification Registry and the Liberia Revenue Authority; no operator, cost or completion date published (2026-03)	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Cybersecurity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Cybersecurity Regulations (LTA-REG-0013-2026)	Did not exist	Requires telecom providers to store personal data and PII primarily inside Liberia's own territory (s.7.3(A)(v)), establish an in-house Cybersecurity Unit within one year of the effective date (s.7.1), notify the LTA of breaches within 24 hours and customers within 72 hours (s.7.6(A)(ii)), run annual penetration testing and keep security-event logs for at least 12 months (s.7.5), and file tested incident-response and continuity plans; the LTA is to run a sector CERT with a 24/7 hotline (s.8.2). Penalties are revenue-linked (up to US\$3,000 plus 0.15% of the preceding year's gross revenue for failing to establish the Unit, escalating to US\$25,000 and possible licence suspension) but apply only from one year after the effective date (s.10.7); the s.10.6 penalty escalation ladder is unreadable in both held copies (2026-01)	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
House investigation into the 2026 data breach	Did not exist	Investigation ordered into an alleged breach of about 2m citizens' data across the revenue, electricity and insurance bodies; no findings published (2026-02)	ADVANCED
National Cybersecurity Act	Scheduled for Q3 2025 by the strategy's action plan, not yet due (2025-08)	No draft, bill or enactment held; the data governance policy of March 2026 names only the unenacted Personal Data Protection and Privacy Act 2024 and Cybercrime Act 2025 (2026-03)	STALLED
National Cybersecurity Council	Scheduled for Q4 2024 by the strategy's action plan, not established (2025-08)	No constituting instrument, membership or meeting record held (2026-08)	STALLED
Cybercrime Act 2025	Not in force	Passed by the Legislature (Senate concurrence communicated to the House 16 January 2026); still unsigned by President Boakai as of 1 July 2026, nearly five months after the House's February 2026 data-breach proceedings	NO CHANGE
National Cybersecurity Strategy 2025-2029	Published, with an action plan dating deliverables from Q4 2024 (2024-07)	Published and unamended; the primary legislation its action plan scheduled for Q3 2025 is not held as delivered (2026-03)	NO CHANGE

Redundancy moved from absent to agreed but not built. At the start of the period international capacity rested solely on the Monrovia landing; by June 2026 there was a [regional agreement to commercialise spare fibre on the CLSG grid](#), and by July a stated second landing at Buchanan and a national data centre, [neither with a partner, cost or date](#). 5G moved the same way, from nothing on record to [plans with investors still being engaged](#).

Two positions worsened. The [traffic-monitoring concession](#) went from operating under a legislature-ratified [agreement to suspended, under renegotiation](#) and the subject of a corruption complaint, leaving the state without its own read on operator traffic. And the market lost a licensee: [Starcell's licence and spectrum were revoked](#) after six years without operating, which removes a dormant competitor rather than adding one.

Cybersecurity gained an investigation and no strategy. The House [ordered a probe into an alleged breach of about 2m citizens' data in February 2026](#); no findings have been published.

Digital public infrastructure

Digital Identity and CRVS

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
National Biometric Identification System (NIR)	Mandatory under Executive Order 147, issuance running amid a procurement dispute over a rejected restricted-bid award (2025-08)	Public-private concession with OSD International to finance enrolment of all about 5.3m people in 18 months, operate and transfer; awaiting legislative ratification, with selection and terms not published (2026-05)	ADVANCED, CONTESTED
National identity enrolment	About 740,000 enrolled, under 15% of about 5.3m, at a US\$5 card fee (2024-12)	About 640,000 prior registrants locked out of the system and issuance halted; no updated enrolment figure published (2026-03)	REGRESSED
Executive Order 147 (mandatory biometric identity)	In force, making the identification number the primary credential for banking, health, education and telecoms (2025-08)	In force and unamended, on a register whose issuance was halted for part of the period (2026-08)	NO CHANGE

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
SIM registration linked to the national identity number	Deadline set and in force (2025-08)	No compliance figure, enforcement action or revised deadline published since (2026-08)	NO CHANGE

Digital Payments and Fintech

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Interoperable payment fee regime	Did not exist	A single charge of no more than 1.0% of value from US\$1.00 to US\$2,000.00 and a flat fee of no more than US\$25.00 above it, available 24 hours a day (2026-08)	ADVANCED
National Electronic Payment Switch	Did not exist	Provided for as the follow-on to the instant payment pilot, alongside person-to-government payments; no go-live date or budget line published (2026-07)	ADVANCED
Pay Na-Na inclusive instant payment system	Did not exist; mobile money split between two closed networks (2025-08)	Interoperable between Lonestar Cell MTN Mobile Money and Orange Money Liberia, covering person-to-person and government-to-person payments (2025-12)	ADVANCED

Registries (population, land, address, etc.)

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
National digital postal address system	Did not exist	Rollout stated as begun in all fifteen counties; no completion date, budget line or addressing standard published (2026-07)	ADVANCED

Other GovTech and e-Gov

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Civil Service Agency automated legal power of attorney platform	Did not exist	In service, tying civil-servant purchases to fingerprint verification against the agency database (2025-12)	ADVANCED
Electronic government procurement platform	Launched nationally in February 2025 after a pilot with six institutions (2025-08)	Phase Two equipment distribution begun on 2026-08-05, with the telecommunications regulator receiving equipment to strengthen its use of the platform under bilateral cooperation with Sierra Leone's procurement authorities reported on 2026-08-12; no transaction count, entity coverage or procurement value is published	ADVANCED
Office of Technology, Digitalization and Innovation (Executive Order 163)	Did not exist	Established as the whole-of-government coordinator for enterprise standards, interoperability, technical clearance of ICT investments and baseline cybersecurity, with 12 months to draft an institutionalising law (2026-04)	ADVANCED
GREAT digital identity and digital government project	Launched at US\$30m to fund the enrolment push (2025-03)	Running, with a US\$2m tranche put on hold during the identity system's debt lock; no disbursement total published (2026-03)	NO CHANGE
Automated telecom licensing and renewal platform	Baseline not held	Rolled out by the telecommunications regulator, letting applicants apply and renew online while in-person service is kept available, as part of a stated shift away from paper-based licensing; no licence count, processing time or fee schedule is published	BASELINE NOT HELD

Payments is the section that moved. The [instant payment system](#) launched on 16 December 2025 in 73 business days, ending the separation of the two mobile-money networks, and its [fee schedule](#) was published in August 2026. A national switch remains provided for and undated.

Identity moved backwards and then sideways. Enrolment stood at [about 740,000 people](#), under 15% of the [population](#), at the start of the period; by March 2026 issuance had stopped and [about 640,000 registrants were locked out of a system whose builder was owed US\\$1.7m](#), with a US\$2m World Bank tranche on hold. The resolution was structural rather than financial: a concession under which [OSD International finances enrolment of all about 5.3m people in 18 months, operates the system and transfers it](#), still unratified and with terms unpublished. No updated enrolment figure has been issued.

Government systems gained a coordinator and two platforms. [Executive Order 163](#) created the whole-of-government digital office in April 2026; the Civil Service Agency's [purchasing platform](#) went live in December 2025; and e-procurement went from a February 2025 launch to [more than 1,200 registered vendors](#) and an export to [Sierra Leone](#), still without award data.

Governance and regulation

Legislation and regulation

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
LTA licensing and spectrum reform package	Licensing under the Telecommunications Act 2007 unchanged, with no satellite or device rules (2025-08)	Split of infrastructure and service licences, tower-sharing rules, first satellite regulations, an IMEI regime and repatriation of the .lr country domain announced; none published as instruments (2026-07)	ADVANCED
Mobile Money Regulations (Central Bank of Liberia)	In force (2025-08)	In force and unamended; the interoperable fee schedule of 2026 was approved under it (2026-08)	NO CHANGE

Strategies, plans and policies

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
African Development Bank Country Strategy Paper 2026-2031	Bank strategy carrying four sectors, ICT among them (2025-08)	Sectors cut from four to three - transport, energy and skills - with an indicative 2026-2028 programme of UA 129m (US\$172.86m, February 2026 conversion), 36.3% unfunded, and no digital lending line (2026-07)	REGRESSED, FOR DIGITAL
Digital Liberia national digital strategy 2025-2029	National ICT Policy and Strategy 2019-2024, already past its stated period (2025-08)	Eight priority areas across four pillars, including universal connectivity, digital addressing, cybersecurity and data sovereignty; no costing or delivery schedule published (2026-02)	ADVANCED
National Data Governance Policy	Did not exist	Final policy designating the Independent Information Commission as data regulator under the unenacted Personal Data Protection and Privacy Act 2024, prescribing signature and ratification of the Malabo Convention, and setting an adequacy-or-explicit-consent rule for personal data leaving the country (2026-03)	ADVANCED

Regional collaboration

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
African Telecommunications Union membership	Voting rights withheld over arrears dating back to 1982 (2025-08)	Arrears waived, current obligations arranged, ratification instrument deposited and voting rights restored (2026-07)	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Liberia-Gambia-Sierra Leone free roaming	In effect, home SIM at local rates across the three countries (2025-08)	In effect; no traffic or price data published (2026-08)	NO CHANGE

Data protection

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Privacy enforcement against telecom operators	Did not exist; no privacy penalty on record (2025-08)	LRD 4m fine (US\$21,900 at the time, per the source) imposed by the telecoms regulator rather than under data-protection law (2026-06)	ADVANCED
Personal Information Act (data protection bill)	Referred to a House committee in June 2025, unpassed, with no national data authority (2025-08)	Still before the legislature and unpassed, with no data-protection authority in existence (2026-05)	NO CHANGE

Public debate and participation in policymaking

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Anti-Corruption Commission complaint against the LTA	Did not exist	Under investigation, with no evidence publicly produced and no findings made (2026-07)	ADVANCED

The data-protection position is identical at both ends of the window: the [Personal Information Act was before a House committee in June 2025 and remains before the legislature](#), with no data-protection authority in existence, over a period in which the state contracted a foreign firm to hold the population's biometric records. What appeared instead was sectoral enforcement: the [first privacy penalty on record, LRD 4m against Orange Liberia in June 2026](#), imposed under telecom regulation.

Policy was made and, in one case, unmade. The ministry [published a five-year digital strategy in February 2026](#) to replace a framework already past its period, and the regulator [announced a licensing overhaul in July 2026](#) that is not yet published as instruments. In the other direction, the African Development Bank's new country strategy [cut its sectors from four to three and left no digital lending line](#).

Regional standing was recovered where domestic transparency was not. Liberia's [African Telecommunications Union vote was restored on a US\\$361,151.36 arrears waiver](#), while the regulator's own revenue went from unpublished to [expressly withheld](#).

Artificial intelligence and the technology sector

AI

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
CJ Lewis legal-learning artificial intelligence	Did not exist	In service over Supreme Court opinions from 1861 to 2026 plus statutes and regulations, built by a private law library with OHCHR support (2026-07)	ADVANCED
National artificial intelligence priority	Did not exist	Accepted in principle, conditioned on applications in agriculture, transport and commerce; no policy, institution, budget line or date attached (2026-07)	ADVANCED

ICT Industry

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Smart ports memorandum with HAROPA PORT	Did not exist	Non-exclusive memorandum covering all four seaports across five areas including automated terminal operations; no commitment amount, implementation date or named system (2026-07)	ADVANCED

Innovation ecosystem

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Lantern GovTech and Cyber Arena platform	BASELINE NOT HELD	Operating and selected to represent Liberia at the global final, pitched on domestic data custody; the firm projects a US\$20m return over five years and plans a domestic security operations centre (2026-07)	Baseline not held
UNIPOD innovation and digital hub	BASELINE NOT HELD	Operating under UNDP Africa's Timbuktoo platform; no commitment amount disclosed (2026-07)	Baseline not held

Artificial intelligence went from absent to acknowledged. It was not a stated government agenda item at the start of the window; by July 2026 the President had [accepted a youth council proposal in principle with no instrument attached](#), and the first working system had launched from the private sector rather than the state: [a legal chatbot over 165 years of Supreme Court opinions](#).

The technology sector's other movement was a memorandum: the port authority's [non-exclusive smart-ports agreement with HAROPA PORT](#), which commits no money and names no system.

Inclusion and capacity

Digital divides

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Internet penetration	1.84m internet users, 32.4% of a 5.67m population, with about 3.8m offline (2025-01)	No later national figure published (2026-08)	NO CHANGE

Access to services

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Account ownership and mobile wallets	52% account ownership with more than 11m wallets (2024)	No later figure published (2026-08)	NO CHANGE

Literacy

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Media and information literacy training for elections	Did not exist	19 young leaders trained in the first of three sessions, run by UNDP with the elections commission and press union on Canadian funding; no budget disclosed (2026-07)	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
MOE Digital Learning Platform and Liberia Learns	Did not exist	In service for Grades 1 to 3 through curriculum-aligned video, audio and radio in local languages, with sign-language interpretation on video lessons (2026-01)	ADVANCED

Training and skills

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
University of Liberia master's programme in artificial intelligence	Did not exist	Announced as the country's first such programme; no start date, intake or funding amount disclosed (2026-08)	ADVANCED

The one place inclusion moved was education: the Ministry of Education's [digital learning platform and radio service for Grades 1 to 3 launched in January 2026](#) and did not exist a year earlier. Neither of the two measures on this ledger moved: [account ownership at 52% with more than 11m wallets](#) and [internet penetration at 32.4%](#) are the last figures published, both predating the window's close by more than a year.

Finance

New investments

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
America First Global Health Strategy health data systems funding	Did not exist	US\$26,133,684 planned over 2026-2030 for health data systems including electronic medical records, a laboratory information system, disease surveillance and DHIS2, non-binding and subject to the availability of funds; the signed text commits Liberia to an open-source EMR rolled out to 100% of public health facilities by 2030 and gives the United States audit access to up to 5% of health facilities, with a data-sharing arrangement still to be negotiated and expected to run ten years, but no specimen-sharing or personal-data clause; the memorandum's text was published in March 2026 and then withdrawn, and is the subject of a federal freedom-of-information suit filed 2 April 2026 (2026-04)	ADVANCED
WARDIP2 financing for Liberia	Did not exist	US\$50m committed for broadband, cybersecurity, digital governance and digital payments within a US\$137m three-country operation (2026-06)	ADVANCED
Youth Entrepreneurship Investment Bank	BASELINE NOT HELD	Almost US\$18m targeting 30,000 youth-led businesses and about 100,000 jobs, with a board being constituted; no disbursement stated (2026-07)	Baseline not held

Two financing commitments entered the ledger without matching disbursement data. The World Bank's WARDIP2 operation [committed US\\$50m of a US\\$125m package signed in June 2026](#) for broadband, cybersecurity, digital governance and payments, and the [Youth Entrepreneurship Investment Bank was stated at almost US\\$18m](#) with nothing disbursed on the record.

Where the record is thin

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
Publication of the telecoms regulator's own revenue	The Authority's licensing fees, spectrum charges, regulatory levies and numbering receipts, or an audited account of them from the General Auditing Commission.	not yet probed
Earth observation or geospatial data programme	A national geospatial or earth-observation programme document, or an agency mandate covering satellite data.	not yet probed
Digitalisation of county and city administration	A county or municipal digital plan, a local service platform, or an administration report on digital service delivery.	not yet probed
Domestic digital research capacity	A university research programme, a published national research output, or an institutional mandate for digital research.	not yet probed
European Union digital cooperation with Liberia	A Global Gateway or EU delegation announcement, a financing agreement, or a programme document naming Liberia.	not yet probed
Indian digital cooperation with Liberia	A bilateral memorandum, a line-of-credit agreement, or an India Stack or ITEC programme document naming Liberia.	not yet probed
Gulf state digital investment in Liberia	An investment agreement, data-centre or connectivity commitment from a Gulf sovereign fund or operator.	not yet probed
Interoperability framework between government registers	The enterprise standards and interoperability rules Executive Order 163 provides for, or a data-sharing instrument between agencies.	not yet probed

Nine rows carry no position at either end, six of them subjects the base holds nothing on and three documents the record points at without containing. Two of the three are instruments the state has itself said it needs: a national cybersecurity strategy, whose absence the House recorded when it ordered the breach investigation, and the interoperability framework the digital-government order provides for. None was probed within this period; each is carried into the next.

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

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Figures are dated because most are time-varying: a figure carries the date it was true, not the date you are reading it. Where the base holds no reliable statement, the document says **Not held** rather than leaving a silence — those are counted, and listed at the end.

This is a dated edition and is not revised after publication. If a figure here has moved, the current edition will say so.